

Lesson 109: Declarer's Deductions

1 DEDUCTIONS FROM THE OPENING LEAD:



No Trump:

- fourth longest suit
- high lead = sequence
- low lead = honor above



Trump:

- sequence
- short for ruff
- partner's suit



2 PASSER DOES NOT HAVE THE OPENING:



PASS

If opponent has passed, they have less than 12 points → distribute the points!

3 COUNT THE SHOWN POINTS:



Every time an opponent plays an honor, note it mentally.

4 DEDUCTION ON DISTRIBUTION:



- From the type of opening (1♥ = 5+ Hearts, 1NT = balanced 15–17)
- From the type of response
- From defensive signals

5 DO NOT TAKE LOSING FINESSES:



If you know the King is on the right, do not finesse to the left!



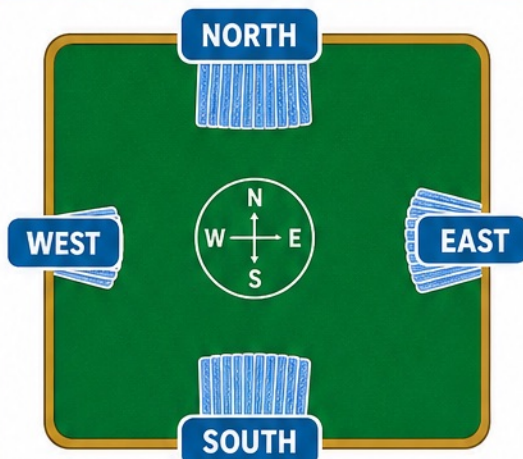
6 DECLARER'S MENTAL MAP:

A Picture of the Deduced Opponents' Points



Keep updating your mental map as the hand progresses!

BRIDGE TABLE: FOUR POSITIONS



Good declarers collect clues, make deductions, and create a plan!

7 EXAMPLE: SOUTH DEFENDER WITH 11 HCP

South's Hand (11 HCP)

♠ A J 8 5
♥ Q 7 4 3
♦ K 6 2
♣ 9 4

A = 4
K = 3
Q = 2
J = 1

Total = 11

WEST OPENS 1NT (15–17, BALANCED)



South knows West is balanced with 15–17 points.
South has 11 points.
So, the other 3 honors (4 points) are in North or East.

WHERE ARE THE MISSING HONORS?

Honor	West	North	East
♠	A J	?	?
♥	Q	?	?
♦	K	?	?
♣	—	?	?
Points	10–12	0–4	0–4

North and East share the remaining 3–7 points.



Use the opening bid, the play, and the signals to refine your deductions!



OBSERVE • DEDUCE • PLAN • SUCCEED!

Maestro Franci